

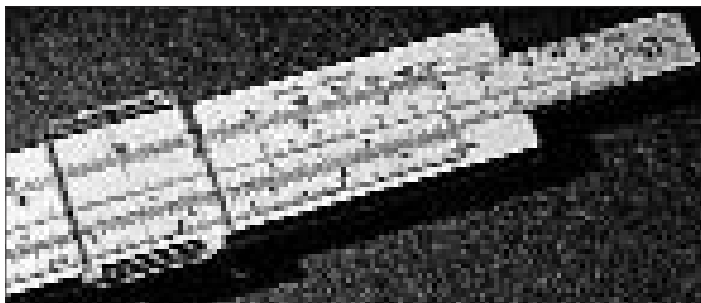
it warned of an overflow by ringing a bell!

And then, in...

1625

...William Oughtred invented the slide rule. We think many of you—at least the old-timers—are familiar with this one. A manual from 1960 said, “A computer who must make many difficult calculations usually has a slide rule close at hand.” Note that “computer” here referred to a person; it was only later that the term got applied to a machine!

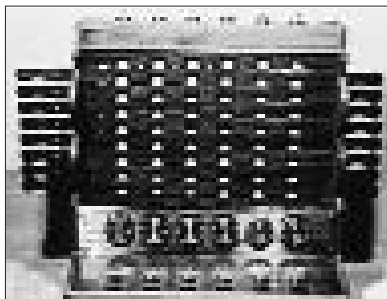
How the slide rule works, in fact, a good tutorial, is at www.sphere.bc.ca/test/howto.html.



A typical slide rule—which you *should* know about!

1642

French mathematician Blaise Pascal (of Pascal programming language fame) built the narcissistically-named Pascaline, a mechanical adding machine. It was limited compared to Schickard's Calculating Clock, but the Pascaline became much more popular. You'll often find the Pascaline quoted, and seldom the Calculating Clock. Pascal actually sold about 12 of them.



The Calculating Clock: fascinatingly complex-looking